

Khawaja Sazzad Ali

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Education

PhD in Economics

University of Wisconsin-Milwaukee

Wisconsin, USA

Sep 2025 – Present

MSc in Economics, GPA: 3.61/4.0 (Distinction)

North South University

Dhaka, Bangladesh

May 2022 – May 2024

- **Thesis:** Is Digital Financial Inclusion a Gateway to Economic Growth for Asian Economies?

BBA in Finance and Marketing, GPA: 3.75/4.0 (Distinction)

North South University

Dhaka, Bangladesh

May 2016 – Dec 2020

Work Experiences

Research Associate

Research and Policy Integration for Development (RAPID)

Dhaka, Bangladesh

Nov 2023 – July 2025

- Led an in-depth situation analysis of Bangladesh's Universal Pension Scheme, conducting KIIs and delivering a comprehensive assessment with strategic recommendations by comparing it to global pension schemes. [[Paper](#)]
- Undertaken a mixed-method approach to assess the effectiveness of the Open Market Sales program through a survey of 2321 households; cleaned and analyzed data to investigate leakage and supply-side constraints to improve targeting efficiency and enhance the program's impact on food security and poverty reduction. [[Paper](#)]
- Authored a policy brief on the multiplier effect of investing in children by reviewing and analyzing existing social protection programs exclusive to children in Bangladesh. [[Policy Brief](#)]
- Facilitated JICA's mission to Bangladesh by preparing a comprehensive report on the social protection system, drafting detailed meeting minutes, and analyzing data from sources including the Labor Force Survey (LFS), Household Income and Expenditure Survey (HIES), and United Nations Department of Economic and Social Affairs (UN DESA) to provide an in-depth understanding and strategic recommendations for the social protection landscape. [[Paper](#)]
- Conducted a comprehensive study to develop a framework for understanding urban poverty and urban social protection, examining its dimensions and characteristics, and identifying eligible urban poor and vulnerable for social protection schemes through FGDs, KIIs, and HIES 2022 data. [[Paper](#)]
- Led the preparation of a technical [report](#) on the consolidation/harmonization of social protection programs in Bangladesh through a series of consultations and discussions with different agencies.
- Researched and analyzed systemic inefficiencies in Bangladesh's social protection system, evaluating the limited impact of the National Social Security Strategy (NSSS) and proposing evidence-based reforms to strengthen resilience and inclusive growth. [[Policy Brief](#)]
- Analyzed inflation erosion in Bangladesh's social protection programs using HIES 2022 data. [[Paper](#)]
- Collaborated on the design and implementation plan for a baseline survey on financial inclusion covering 6912 households, including questionnaire preparation, sampling methodology, and survey execution. [[Website](#)]
- Authored Bangladesh's Voluntary National Review (VNR) 2025, synthesizing data from government, civil society, and development partners to assess national achievements, challenges, and policy priorities for inclusive and sustainable development. [[Report](#)]
- Authored a policy brief advocating effective support for migrant workers, highlighting gaps in current systems and proposing practical reforms. [[Policy Brief](#)]
- Authored a [working paper](#) using QGIS and micro-simulation to estimate and analyze district-level targeting errors in Bangladesh's social protection system, uncovering geographic disparities and simulating redistributive impacts of reallocating benefits to households under the poverty line.

Mentor and Lead Author*PaperPal**Dhaka, Bangladesh**Jul 2012 – Present*

- Taught O- and A-level subjects, including Math, Economics, Physics, ICT, English, and Bengali, through engaging online and offline sessions tailored to diverse learning needs.
- Created detailed lecture notes and learning aids to simplify complex concepts, enhancing student understanding and retention.
- Graded tests, provided constructive feedback, and developed personalized strategies to address individual learning gaps and promote academic improvement.
- Conducted in-depth research and crafted well-structured academic reports as a freelance writer, meeting stringent formatting and citation standards.
- Delivered insightful and well-researched reports across various disciplines, ensuring clarity, coherence, and adherence to client requirements.

Research Assistant*North South University**Dhaka, Bangladesh**Sep 2022 – Nov 2023*

- Developed comprehensive survey and FGD questionnaires tailored to diverse demographic cohorts, ensuring relevance and clarity for effective data collection.
- Moderated FGD sessions across various demographic groups capturing nuanced perspectives on insurance accessibility and inclusivity.
- Conducted field surveys across all eight divisions of Bangladesh, gathering data from 7,500 households to ensure robust and representative findings.
- Cleaned and analyzed qualitative and quantitative datasets to identify key patterns and trends, using advanced statistical techniques for rigorous insights.
- Provided actionable policy recommendations to stakeholders, focusing on improving the efficiency, accessibility, and inclusivity of insurance services in Bangladesh.

Research Assistant*Institutional Quality Assurance Cell (IQAC)**Dhaka, Bangladesh**Dec 2020 – Mar 2022*

- Conducted FGDs and surveys for the Outcome-Based Education (OBE) project, engaging with diverse participants to gather comprehensive data.
- Mined, filtered, transcribed, and analyzed qualitative and quantitative data using SPSS and other relevant tools, ensuring accuracy and reliability in findings.
- Utilized AMOS for structural equation modeling (SEM) to explore and model complex relationships within the data, providing nuanced insights into key variables.
- Employed Tableau to create dynamic and interactive visualizations, enabling stakeholders to interpret and understand research findings effectively.

Research Assistant*North South University**Dhaka, Bangladesh**Jun 2019 – Dec 2019*

- Collected and organized critical financial data from the Bangladesh Stock Exchange, ensuring accuracy and completeness for in-depth analysis.
- Analyzed different financial aspects of publicly listed companies for financial valuations, supporting robust and informed decision-making.

Teaching Assistant*North South University**Dhaka, Bangladesh**Jun 2017 – Dec 2019*

- Supervised undergraduate students in Financial Derivatives, Investment Analysis, Linear Algebra, and Calculus delivering comprehensive course materials and utilizing interactive teaching methods, including financial modeling software and data analysis platforms, to foster a strong foundational

understanding and improve learning outcomes.

- Conducted assessments and provided actionable feedback to improve analytical and problem-solving skills.
- Organized workshops and tutorials to prepare students for competitive exams and certifications.
- Contributed to curriculum development, aligning courses with industry standards.

Publications (C=Conference, J=Journal, CS=Case, B=Book Chapter, O=Op-Ed)

- [CS.1] Islam, Q.T., Hossain, M.I. Islam, Q.T., and **Ali, K.S.** (2026). [Eco-Mobility Evolution: Velvoo's Strategic Drive in Armenia](#) In *SAGE Business Cases*.
- [CS.2] Islam, Q.T., Islam, Q.T., and **Ali, K.S.** (2025). [Innovating Logistics: The Shiprocket Blueprint for E-commerce Excellence in India](#) In *SAGE Business Cases*.
- [B.1] **Ali, K.S.**, Islam, Q.T., Talukder S. (2025). [Empowering Change: The Role of Women in STEM for Achieving SDGs](#). In *African Women Trailblazers in STEM: Pioneering Technological and Economic Advancement*, Taylor and Francis Publishing Limited.
- [CS.3] Goel, R., Singh, T., **Ali, K.S.**, Hossain, M.A. and Islam, Q.T. (2025). [Treading Waters of Change: Watsan Envirotech's Voyage Toward SDG 6 Through Social Entrepreneurship in Rural India](#). In *SAGE Business Cases*.
- [CS.4] Islam, Q. T., Islam, Q. T., and **Ali, K.S.** (2024). [Innovating Logistics: The Shiprocket Blueprint for E-commerce Excellence in India](#). In *SAGE Business Cases*.
- [J.1] Siddiqui, N., Nahar, N., Hossain, M. S., Tazmeen, A., and **Ali, K.S.** (2024). [Context-specific adaptation of a student engagement measure: a case study of a private university in Bangladesh](#). *Cogent Education*, Vol. 11, Issue 1. DOI: [10.1080/2331186X.2024.2380638](#)
- [B.2] Islam, Q. T., Kabir, N., and **Ali, K.S.** (2024). [Neuroeconomic Insights into Consumer Behavior towards Circular Economy Practices](#). In *Chaos, Complexity, and Sustainability in Management*, pp. 185–210. IGI Global. DOI: [10.4018/979-8-3693-2125-6.ch010](#)
- [CS.5] **Ali, K.S.**, et al. (2023). [SWAP: A sustainable solution to our E-waste problem](#). In *SAGE Business Cases*.
- [B.3] **Ali, K.S.** and Faroque, A. (2023). [Addressing the Complexity of the Digital Divide and the Role of Government in Addressing it](#). In *Fostering Sustainable Businesses in Emerging Economies: The Impact of Technology*, pp. 127–145. Emerald Publishing Ltd. DOI: [10.1108/978-1-80455-640-520231009](#)
- [C.1] Nahar, N., Siddiqui, N., Hossain, M. S., Tazmeen, A., and **Ali, K.S.** (2022). [Path to outcome-based higher education in Bangladesh: An analysis of student engagement and socio-demographic factors](#). In *IEEE Global Engineering Education Conference (EDUCON)*, IEEE, 28–31 March, Tunis, Tunisia. DOI: [10.1109/EDUCON52537.2022.9766558](#)
- [O.1] Islam, Q. T., and **Ali, K.S.** (2022). [How to revive the pre-Covid teaching environment in educational institutions](#). In *The Business Standard*, 13 May 2022.

Skills and Competencies

- **Survey Programming:** KoboToolBox, Qualtrics, SurveyCTO
- **Statistical Analysis:** STATA, R, Python, SPSS, AMOS, Excel, NVivo
- **Visualization:** Tableau, PowerBI, QGIS
- **Typesetting:** L^AT_EX

References

1. **Dr. Rebecca Neumann**
Professor and Undergraduate Advisor, Department of Economics, University of Wisconsin-Milwaukee
Email: rneumann@uwm.edu Phone: Can be provided upon request
2. **Dr. Itziar Lazkano**
Associate Professor and Graduate Advisor, Department of Economics, University of Wisconsin-Milwaukee
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